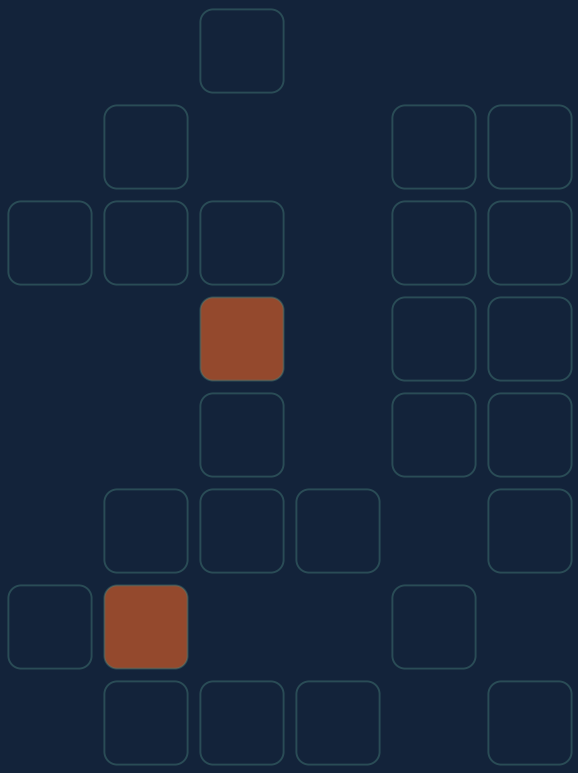
THE LSI TOOLKIT



TOOL 02 OF 04 · RFQ TEMPLATE

Request for Qualifications: Learning Space Integrator

Qualifications-Based Selection for Educational Learning Environments

learningspaceintegrator.com · Version 2.0 · 2026

Industry Standard Template • Not affiliated with any vendor or proprietary methodology

How to use this template: Replace every highlighted [bracketed field] with your district's information, delete these instruction boxes, and have your Purchasing Director and Legal Counsel review the final document before issuing.

Issuing Organization	[District Name]
RFQ Number	[RFQ Number]
Contact Person	[Procurement Contact Name, Title]
Contact Email / Phone	[Email] • [Phone]
RFQ Issue Date	[Date]
Questions Deadline	[Date — recommend 2 weeks after issue]
Submission Deadline	[Date and Time] — [Delivery method]
Anticipated Award	[Month, Year]

Important: All questions must be submitted in writing to the contact above by the Questions Deadline. Answers will be distributed to all invited firms simultaneously. Oral questions and answers are not binding.

LSI TOOLKIT · 02 RFQ TEMPLATE

Section 1: Introduction and District Overview

1.1 About [District Name]

[District Name] is a [public/private] school district serving [number] students across [number] schools and [number] buildings in [City, State]. We are committed to [brief statement of educational mission and values — 1–2 sentences in your own words].

[Optional: describe any recent instructional initiatives, strategic plan priorities, or curriculum shifts driving this project. This gives LSI firms the context they need to understand what you are truly trying to accomplish.]

1.2 Purpose of This RFQ

[District Name] is seeking a qualified Learning Space Integrator (LSI) to assist the district in designing, procuring, and implementing integrated learning environments at [specify: one school / multiple schools / district-wide]. An LSI is a specialized consulting firm that helps school districts create learning spaces aligned

with their educational vision — from physical design and furniture through technology integration and professional development.

This document is an RFQ — a qualifications-first solicitation. Firms are evaluated on their experience, methodology, and alignment with our district's educational goals. Pricing is finalized after a qualified partner is selected, through direct negotiation.

> **Note to district:** Districts using an RFP process — where technical qualifications and price are evaluated simultaneously with predetermined weights — should adapt Section 4 accordingly. Consult your Purchasing Director and Legal Counsel to confirm which pathway is appropriate for your district and state.

1.3 Project Scope Summary

> This project will be scoped and managed school by school (or building by building). Each school will have its own defined scope, timeline, budget, and deliverables. Firms must demonstrate the capacity to manage and be accountable for each site as a distinct project.

Buildings included in this RFQ:

Building / School	Grade Level	Approximate Budget Range
[School Name]	[K-5 / 6-8 / 9-12]	[$xxx,xxx – $xxx,xxx]
[School Name]	[K-5 / 6-8 / 9-12]	[$xxx,xxx – $xxx,xxx]
[School Name]	[K-5 / 6-8 / 9-12]	[$xxx,xxx – $xxx,xxx]

Add or remove rows as needed. Describe each building's scope in detail in Section 2.

Section 2: Scope of Work

2.1 Services Requested

The selected LSI will be expected to provide the following services. Proposers should indicate which services they can provide and how they propose to deliver each.

Core services:

- Educational visioning and stakeholder engagement — understanding how the district and each building want students to learn, not just what furniture to buy
- Learning environment assessment — evaluating existing spaces at each school
- Space design and planning — layout, furniture, technology, and environment — organized by building
- Vendor-neutral product selection and procurement management
- Project management and implementation — site-by-site accountability
- Teacher and staff professional development and change management
- Budget management per project site
- Post-implementation support and outcome evaluation — including space utilization, educator adoption, instructional practice change, and stakeholder perception (not standardized test scores)
- Universal design, accessibility, and inclusive learning environment planning — for students with disabilities, sensory differences, and diverse learning needs

Optional / additional services (indicate which you offer):

- ☐ Professional development beyond initial implementation
- ☐ Ongoing assessment and space iteration
- ☐ Grant writing support
- ☐ Community engagement and communication
- ☐ Other: [specify]

2.2 Scope by Building

> Duplicate this section for each building in the project. The school-by-school structure is intentional — it creates clear accountability and allows the district to manage each project independently.

Building 1: [School Name]

Grade levels	[K-5 / 6-8 / 9-12]
Approximate enrollment	[#] students
Project start	[Month, Year]
Spaces included	[List classrooms, common areas, media center, etc. Include square footage and number of rooms if known.]
Primary learning goals	[What instructional approach or learning model is this school working toward? Describe in 2–4 sentences. This is the most important thing you can tell the LSI.]
Known constraints	[Construction timeline, existing technology, budget ceiling, board approvals required, etc.]
Approved budget	$ [Amount] — [note any conditions or approval stages]

[Add Building 2, Building 3, etc. as needed.]

2.3 Contract Structure

The district anticipates awarding a single contract to one LSI for the full scope described in this RFQ. The contract will be structured with separate scopes, milestones, and budgets for each building, allowing the district to:

- Manage each school as a distinct project
- Phase work and funding independently per building
- Evaluate performance at each site before proceeding to the next
- Address any performance issues at one school before they affect others

Section 3: Proposal Requirements

> Proposals must address all sections below. Proposals that do not address a required section will be evaluated at a disadvantage. All proposals will be evaluated using the same criteria and scoring rubric.

3.1 Cover Letter

Maximum one page, addressed to [Contact Name, Title] at [District Name]. Include:

- Firm name, address, primary contact, and contact information
- A brief statement of your interest in this project and why your firm is well suited
- Confirmation that the primary contact has authority to enter into agreements on behalf of the firm
- Signature of an authorized principal

3.2 Conflict of Interest Disclosure

> **Required.** All proposers must complete and submit this disclosure. A conflict of interest does not automatically disqualify a firm, but failure to disclose one may. The district evaluates disclosed conflicts as part of the overall assessment.

Disclose any of the following:

- Any exclusive financial relationship, commission, rebate arrangement, or other financial incentive the firm receives from furniture manufacturers, technology vendors, or materials suppliers — including any arrangement where the firm receives a fee, rebate, or benefit based on what products the district purchases
- Any ownership interest in, or affiliated relationship with, a furniture dealer, technology vendor, or materials supplier
- Any current or recent (within 3 years) employment relationship between your firm's staff and vendors you might recommend for this project
- Any other relationship that a reasonable person might view as a potential conflict of interest in this engagement

If none of the above apply, state: "Our firm has no conflicts to disclose for this engagement as of [date]."

Disclosure:

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3.3 Firm Qualifications and Experience

Describe your firm's qualifications and relevant experience. This section carries significant weight in evaluation.

Firm overview

- Firm name, year founded, and number of full-time employees
- Physical location(s) and any regional offices relevant to this project
- Annual revenue range (optional but helpful for assessing capacity)

Relevant experience — at least three project case studies required. For each case study, provide:

- District name and location (may be anonymized if the client requests)
- Project scope and number of buildings or schools
- Project budget (total and per building)
- Your firm's specific role and services delivered
- Timeline: start date, completion date, and any notable delays and how they were resolved
- Outcomes: how did the space change how students and teachers worked? Describe outcomes using appropriate measures — space utilization, educator adoption, instructional practice change, student or staff perception — not standardized test scores, which are not valid measures of learning environment effectiveness
- Accessibility impact: how did the space serve students with disabilities, diverse learning needs, or historically underserved groups?
- Reference contact (name, title, phone, email)

Case Study 1

District name / location	
Project scope	
Budget	
Your role	
Timeline	
Outcomes	
Accessibility impact	
Reference contact	

Case Study 2

District name / location	
Project scope	
Budget	
Your role	
Timeline	
Outcomes	
Accessibility impact	
Reference contact	

Case Study 3

District name / location	
Project scope	
Budget	
Your role	
Timeline	
Outcomes	
Accessibility impact	
Reference contact	

3.4 Team Qualifications

Identify the specific individuals who would be assigned to this project. For each person, provide:

- Name and title
- Role on this project
- Years of relevant experience in K-12 learning environment work
- Relevant credentials or certifications
- Brief biography or resume (attach as an appendix)

Also address:

- Who is the primary point of contact for [District Name] during the engagement?
- What is your firm's staff capacity to take on this project given your current workload?
- Would any portion of this work be subcontracted? If so, to whom and for what?

3.5 Methodology and Project Approach

This is the most important section of your proposal. Describe in detail how your firm would approach this specific project — not a generic description of your process.

Topic	Address in your response
Educational visioning	How do you help a district clarify and articulate its educational vision? What does your process look like in practice? How many stakeholders do you typically engage, and how?

Topic	Address in your response
School-by-school project management	How do you structure your work when managing multiple buildings? How do you ensure each school gets dedicated attention and accountability? Describe your approach to scoping, scheduling, and managing each building as a distinct project.
Vendor selection and product procurement	Describe your approach to selecting furniture and technology vendors. How do you ensure recommendations are objective and in the district's best interest? Any preferred vendors or financial relationships must also be disclosed in Section 3.2.
Change management and professional development	How do you prepare teachers and staff to use new learning spaces effectively? Describe a specific example of how your change management approach worked in a prior project.
Managing on budget and on time	Describe your approach to budget management. How do you handle cost overruns or unexpected expenses? Give an example of a project that faced budget or timeline challenges and how you managed it.

3.6 Fee Structure and Budget Transparency

Provide a clear, detailed description of how your firm charges for services.

Fee structure. Describe your typical fee model:

- Do you charge a flat project fee, hourly rate, percentage of project budget, or a combination?
- What is included in your base fee, and what is billed separately?
- How do you handle travel and expense reimbursement?
- How do you structure fees when a project has multiple buildings?

Estimated fee for this engagement. Provide your estimated total fee for the scope described in Section 2, organized by building and service category. If you cannot provide a precise estimate without more information, provide a fee range and explain what would move your fee toward the higher or lower end.

> **Note to district:** Do not ask for a firm fixed price at the RFQ stage — LSIs cannot price a project accurately without a discovery phase. Ask for a fee structure and estimated range, and negotiate the actual contract after you have selected your preferred firm.

Building / Phase	Estimated Fee	Services Included
[School 1]	$	[Describe what is included]
[School 2]	$	[Describe what is included]
[School 3]	$	[Describe what is included]
Total	$	

Vendor relationships and compensation disclosure. If your firm receives any form of compensation, rebate, commission, or other financial benefit from any vendor whose products you might recommend to [District Name], describe it here in detail. This includes any arrangement — regardless of how it is structured or labeled — where your firm receives a financial benefit based on what the district purchases. Firms with such arrangements are not automatically disqualified, but full disclosure is required.

Section 4: Evaluation Criteria and Process

4.1 Evaluation Criteria

All proposals will be evaluated by a committee using the following criteria and weights. These criteria will not change after the RFQ is issued.

#	Criterion Area	District Weight	What we look for
1	Relevant Experience & Past Performance	_____ %	K-12 case studies; references; comparable scope
2	Educational / Learning Environment Approach	_____ %	Vision first; learning science; accessibility and inclusion
3	Stakeholder Engagement & Discovery	_____ %	Breadth; student voice; conflict resolution
4	Design & Planning Methodology	_____ %	Site-specific; flexible; integrated
5	Implementation & Project Management	_____ %	School-by-school accountability; on time and on budget
6	Budget, Cost Transparency & Value	_____ %	Fee clarity; realistic; justified value
7	Product Sourcing & Procurement Transparency	_____ %	Vendor disclosure; objective recommendations
8	Partnership, Governance & Communication	_____ %	Responsiveness; personnel continuity; trust
9	Outcomes, Evaluation & Continuous Improvement	_____ %	Utilization; adoption; perception measurement
	Total	**100%**	Must equal 100% before issuing

Weights are determined by the district before this RFQ is issued and cannot change after proposals are received. The full scoring rubric is available in the LSI Evaluation Scorecard.

> **Note on vendor transparency:** Vendor transparency is evaluated as a scored criterion (Criterion 7 — Product Sourcing & Procurement Transparency). All proposers must also complete the mandatory disclosure in Section 3.2. Firms with disclosed relationships are not automatically disqualified, but the quality and completeness of their disclosure and the adequacy of their conflict management approach are scored.

4.2 Evaluation Process

Step	Stage	What happens
1	Administrative review	All proposals are checked for completeness. Proposals missing required sections (especially Section 3.2 — Conflict of Interest Disclosure) may be deemed non-responsive.
2	Independent scoring	Each committee member scores each complete proposal independently using the criteria above.
3	Consensus discussion	The committee meets to discuss scores and reach consensus.
4	Reference checks	References for the top-scoring 2–3 firms are contacted.
5	Finalist interviews	Top-scoring firms are invited to an in-person or virtual interview.
6	Selection and award	The committee selects the highest-scoring firm and proceeds to contract negotiation.
7	Notification	All proposing firms are notified of the award decision in writing.

4.3 Finalist Interviews

Finalist interviews will be held approximately [date range] and will be [60–90] minutes long. All finalist firms will be asked the same core questions. Firms should plan to bring the specific team members who would be assigned to this project.

Section 5: Terms, Conditions, and Submission

5.1 Submission Instructions

Submit your proposal by the deadline stated on the cover page. Late proposals will not be accepted.

- **Format:** [Electronic via email / Online portal / Physical copies — specify]. Electronic submissions must be in PDF format. File naming convention: [District abbreviation]_LSI_RFQ_[FirmName].pdf
- **Number of copies:** [Specify if physical copies are required]
- **Submit to:** [Name, Title, Address/Email]

5.2 Questions and Addenda

- All questions must be submitted in writing by the Questions Deadline listed on the cover page
- Questions must be sent to [Contact email]
- Answers to all questions will be compiled and distributed to all invited firms by [date]
- Any changes to this RFQ will be issued as a written addendum to all invited firms
- Oral responses to questions are not binding

5.3 General Terms

- The district reserves the right to reject any or all proposals, to waive any informality, and to accept the proposal deemed most advantageous to the district
- The district is not obligated to accept the lowest-fee proposal
- Proposals and all submitted materials become the property of the district and are subject to public disclosure laws
- The district is not responsible for costs incurred by firms in preparing proposals
- Proposers must maintain the confidentiality of any district information provided during this process
- The district may cancel this RFQ at any time without obligation

5.4 Equal Opportunity Statement

[District Name] is an equal opportunity employer and does not discriminate on the basis of race, color, national origin, sex, disability, or age in its programs and activities. [District Name] encourages proposals from minority-owned, women-owned, and small businesses.

5.5 Contract

The selected firm will be required to enter into a written contract with [District Name] before beginning work. The district will provide a standard professional services agreement; the selected firm's standard agreement may also be considered. Key contract elements will include scope of work, schedule, deliverables, fee structure, insurance requirements, termination provisions, and conflict of interest representations.

5.6 Insurance Requirements

The selected firm must maintain the following insurance coverage throughout the engagement:

- Commercial general liability: $ [amount] per occurrence / $ [amount] aggregate
- Professional liability (errors and omissions): $ [amount] per claim
- Workers' compensation: as required by state law
- [Add any additional district-specific requirements]

Section 6: Required Attachments

Include the following with your proposal. Label each attachment clearly.

✓	Attachment	Description
☐	A: Conflict of Interest Disclosure	Signed statement per Section 3.2 (required — proposals without it will be deemed non-responsive)
☐	B: Case Studies (3 minimum)	Full case studies in the Section 3.3 format, including reference contacts
☐	C: Team Resumes / Bios	One page per team member assigned to this project
☐	D: Certificate of Insurance	Current certificate showing all required coverage
☐	E: Business References	Three professional references who are not case study contacts (name, title, organization, phone, email)
☐	F: Other Supporting Materials	Optional: additional case studies, awards, relevant publications, etc.

Section 7: Proposer Certification and Signature

> By signing below, the proposer certifies that: (1) all information in this proposal is true and accurate; (2) all conflict of interest disclosures are complete and accurate; (3) the proposer has the legal authority to submit this proposal; (4) the proposer will maintain the quoted fee structure for [60/90] days from the submission deadline; and (5) the proposer has not engaged in any collusion with other proposers.

Organization Name	
Primary Contact Name and Title	
Address	
Phone	
Email	
Authorized Signature	
Printed Name and Title	
Date	

Appendix: District Educational Vision Statement

Complete this section before issuing the RFQ. It is one of the most important things you can give LSI firms. It tells them what you are truly trying to accomplish — not just which rooms you want to renovate. A strong vision statement describes how you want students to learn, not what furniture you want to buy.

Prompts to help you draft it:

- What does a typical great learning day look like at our schools today? What does it look like in our vision?
- What instructional approaches are we moving toward? (Project-based learning, station rotation, collaborative inquiry, etc.)
- What student skills and dispositions are we most focused on developing?
- What gets in the way of the learning we want today? What physical barriers or limitations exist?
- What would "success" look like three years after implementation?

[District Name] Educational Vision for Learning Environments:

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